



HARVESTING

Onions are ready to harvest when their leaves die down and topple over. Carefully ease them out of the ground with a fork. If the weather is clear, leave them to dry on the ground. In wet weather, lifted onions rot quickly, so bring them indoors to dry off thoroughly on a rack or tray.

STORING

Once the skins have turned papery, store onions in a light, well-ventilated area. Braid the leaves into a rope and hang the onions up, or place them in single layers in slatted trays, or in a net.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Onions are susceptible to downy mildew in wet conditions. Other diseases include onion white rot, which affects the base, and onion neck rot, common in stored bulbs. Onion fly is a serious pest but less likely to affect onions grown from sets. Birds may target sets.



Remove and destroy infected foliage.